

Team Number: _____

Time: _____

Rank: _____



SMALL BUSINESS MANAGEMENT TEAM

(510)

STATE 2021

PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points _____ (140 points)

Specification Points _____ (30 points)

TOTAL POINTS _____ (170 points)

Preparation Time: 30 minutes

Description:

The team will use strategic planning and problem-solving skills to provide solutions to the business case study provided. At State and National levels, teams will be presented with an additional element to the scenario that requires revision of their final presentation.

Modification at State Preliminary Competition:

Ms. Jones has always had a robust clientele from the local surrounding area. This is partially due to the logistics of traveling to the events and delivering products to clients. Are there products/services Katie can create using her skills that would be marketable to people outside of her local area? How can she deliver the products/services without incurring too much extra cost?

Initial Case Study Topic:

A local business owner, Katie Jones, is looking for ways to improve her photography business. She has been taking professional photos for several years and has built clientele from the local area and surrounding cities. She takes photos for weddings, birthdays, family pictures, and other significant life events. The business keeps her extremely busy and takes away a significant amount of time from her family and other personal pursuits. She would like to spend less time working in order to spend more time with her family and pursue other types of photography but has to continue making the revenue she has been making in order to make her business worth her time and pay for equipment upgrades. She has hired your team to help her devise some business strategies that will help her continue her business and achieve her personal goals.

Currently, a client will book an appointment with Katie. She will prepare for the event, take the photos, and then spend time editing the photos and creating the products the client asks for. Most of the products Katie prints are outsourced and shipped to Katie, who then delivers the products. The majority of products are just normal photo prints of different sizes. She has thought about creating new products, but isn't sure what to create or if the cost will be worth it to her clients as they order what they specifically want. Her prices are all individually contracted without a pricing system because each event and its needs are uniquely different.

Katie has thought through some of the obvious factors. She knows she needs to generate more revenue. She could easily charge more money across all levels of her business, but since most of her clients are local, charging more money will break the personal connection; and they will hire a different photographer for less money.

Another limiting factor is time. She has thought about hiring help. Having help with taking and editing photos would easily free up her time, but she is worried about quality control and still making enough money for herself after paying the employees. Another position she has thought about hiring is an assistant who would help with scheduling, but again is afraid that her revenue stream is not large enough to cover the new expense.

Prepare a presentation for Katie with your suggestions for her company including, but not limited to, the questions below.

- How can Katie generate more revenue without spending more time working on the business?
- How can Katie alleviate her time spent on the business without generating less revenue/profit?
- What types of hired positions could Katie use to efficiently grow her business?
- Are there different products and services Katie can offer?
- How can all of the discussed elements help Katie feel confident that her business will grow and protect everything she has worked for (i.e., profit, reputation, etc.)?

A team will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Teams who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.